

# **Detection of Software Vulnerabilities: Dynamic Analysis**

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# Security in the Development Lifecycle

- A majority of **security defects** and vulnerabilities in software are **not directly related to functionality**

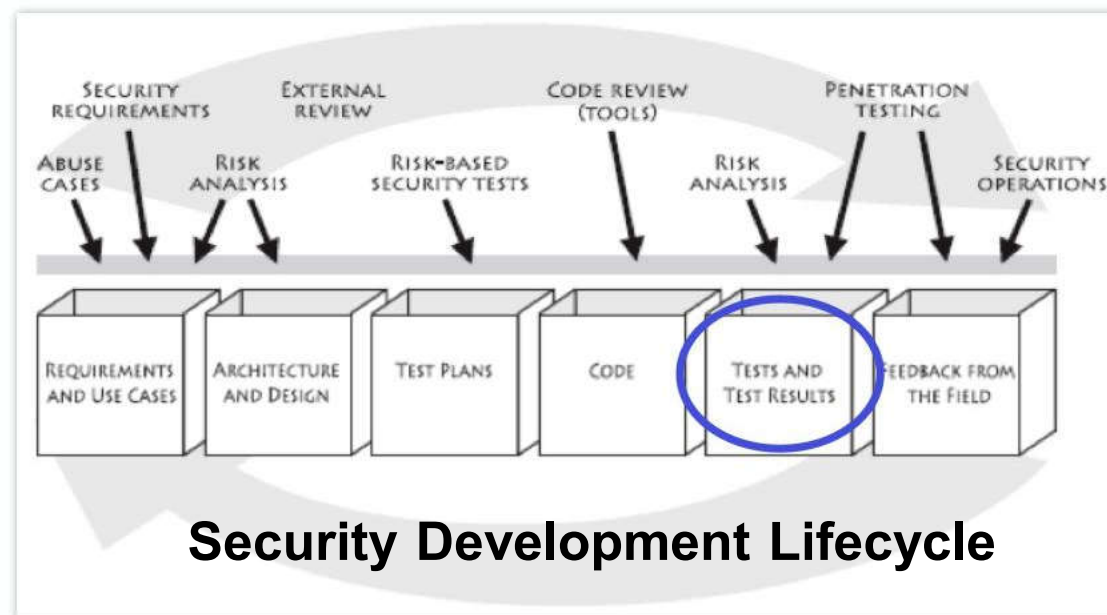
# Security in the Development Lifecycle

- **Security testing:** white hat, red hat, and penetration



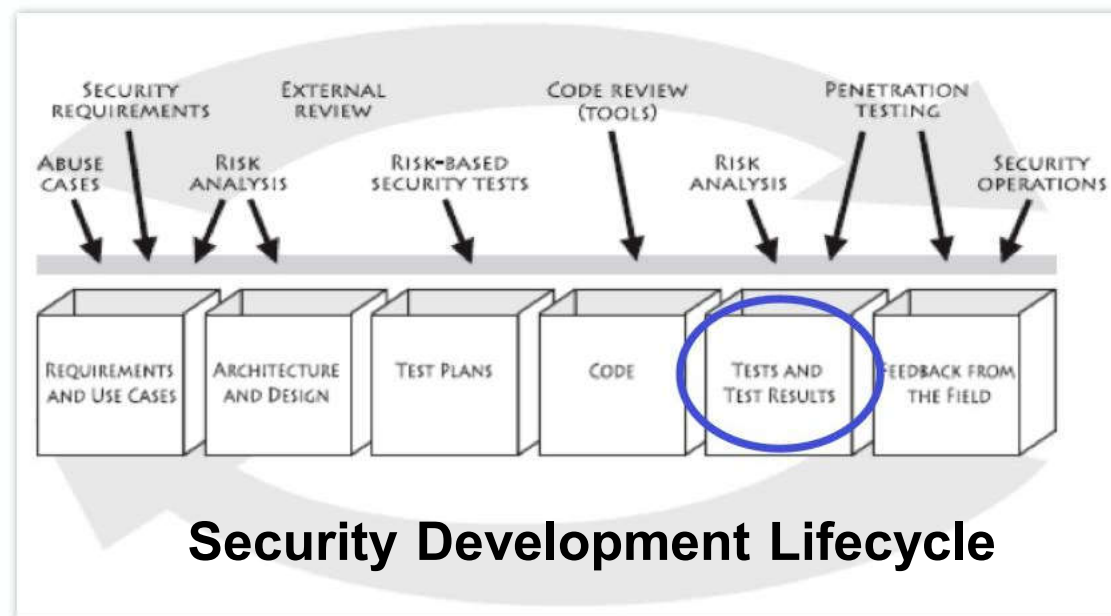
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- **Testing for a negative** poses a much greater challenge than **verifying for a positive**

# Testing for functionality vs testing for security

- Traditional testing checks functionalities for sensible inputs and corner conditions

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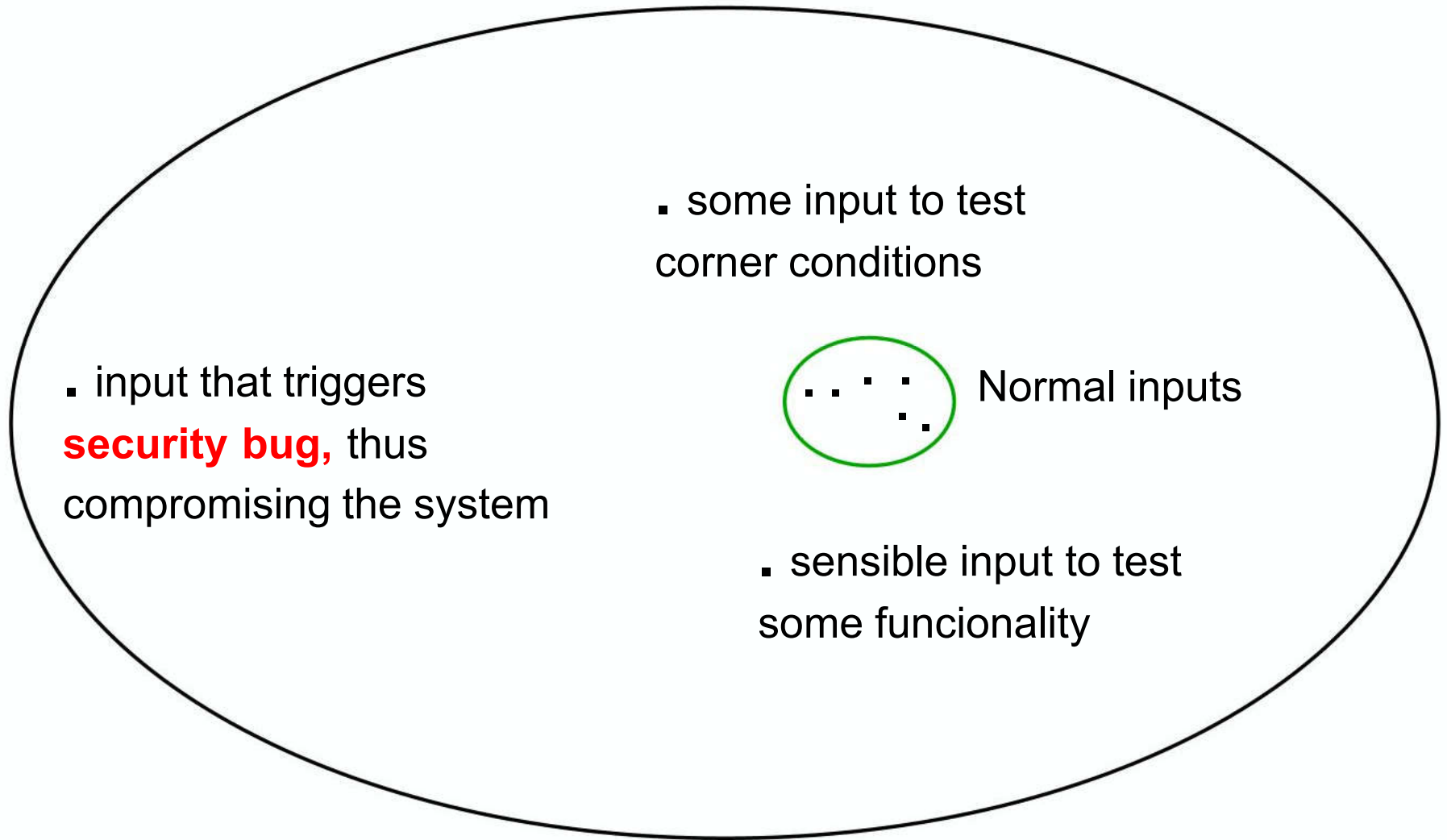
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# Testing for functionality vs testing for security

- **Traditional testing** checks **functionalities** for **sensible inputs** and **corner conditions**
- **Security testing** also requires looking for the wrong, unwanted behavior for **uncommon inputs**
- **Routine use** of a software system is more likely to reveal **functional problems** than **security problems**:
  - **users** will complain about **functional problems**, but **hackers** will not complain about **security problems**

# Security testing is difficult

space of all possible inputs



# Definition of Test Suite and Oracle

- To test a software system, we need:

① **test suite:** a collection of input data

② **test oracle:** decides if a test succeeded or led to an error

➤ some way to decide if the software behaves as we want

# Definition of Test Suite and Oracle

- To test a software system, we need:
  - ① **test suite**: a collection of input data
  - ② **test oracle**: decides if a test succeeded or led to an error
    - some way to decide if the software behaves as we want
- Define both test suites and test oracles can be a **significant work**
  - A test oracle consists of a long list, which **for every individual test case, specifies what should happen**
  - A **simple test oracle**: just looking if the application does not crash



# Statement Coverage

- **Statement coverage** involves the execution of all the executable statements at least once
  - $(\text{executed statements} / \text{total statements}) * 100$

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         *res = 0;
6         return 1;
7     } else if(a == 1) {
8         *res = b;
9         return 1;
10    } else if(b == 1) {
11        *res = a;
12        return 1;
13    }
14    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
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```

a=0,b=0

Coverage=3/11=27%

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a=1,b=3

Coverage=4/11=36%

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```

a=2,b=1

Coverage=5/11=45%

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a=2,b=2

Coverage=5/11=45%

# Statement Coverage

- **Statement coverage** involves the execution of all the executable statements at least once
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| Test Case | Value of "a" | Value of "b" | Value of "res" | Statement Coverage |
|-----------|--------------|--------------|----------------|--------------------|
| 1         | 0            | 0            | 0              | 27%                |
| 2         | 1            | 3            | b              | 36%                |
| 3         | 2            | 1            | a              | 45%                |
| 4         | 2            | 2            | a * b          | 45%                |

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```
1 void Demo(int a) {  
2     if (a > 5)  
3         a = a*3;  
4     printf("a: %i"\n);  
5 }
```

a=4

(a>5) is false

Decision coverage = 50%



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```
1 void Demo(int a) {  
2     if (a > 5)  
3         a = a*3;  
4     printf("a: %i"\n);  
5 }
```

a=10

(a>5) is **true**

Decision coverage = 50%

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1 void Demo(int a) {  
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```

| Test Case | Value of "a" | Output | Decision Coverage |
|-----------|--------------|--------|-------------------|
| 1         | 4            | 4      | 50%               |
| 2         | 10           | 30     | 50%               |

# Branch Coverage

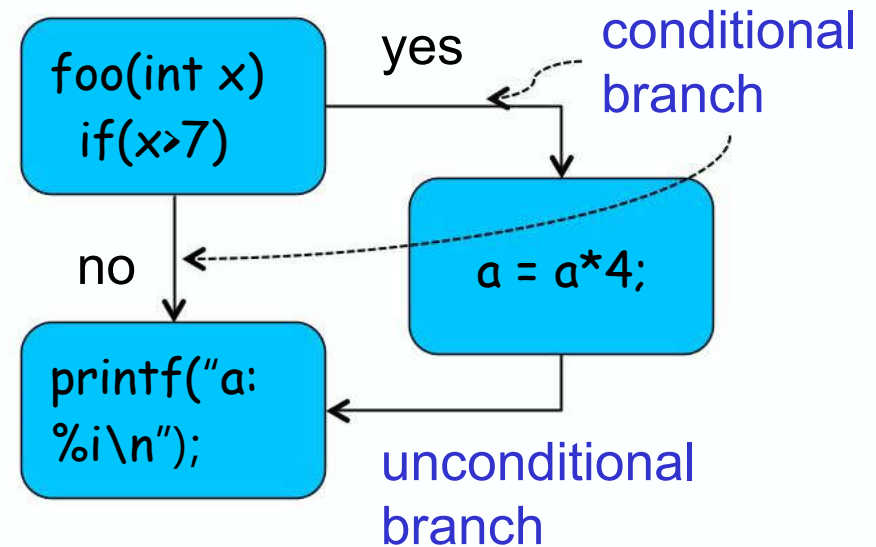
- **Branch coverage** tests every outcome from the code to ensure that every branch is executed at least once
  - $(\text{executed branches} / \text{total branches}) * 100$

```
1 void foo(int x) {  
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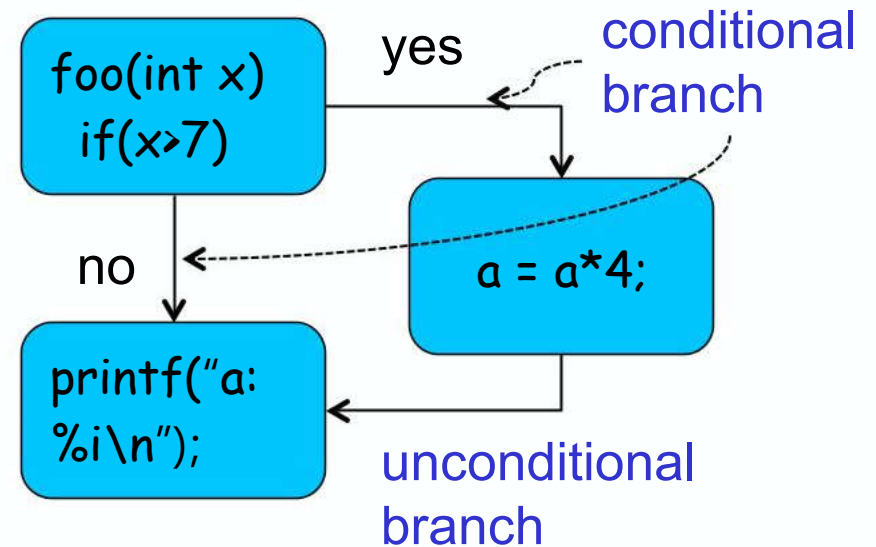
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5 }
```



| Test Case | Value of "a" | Output | Decision Coverage | Branch Coverage |
|-----------|--------------|--------|-------------------|-----------------|
| 1         | 4            | 4      | 50%               | 33%             |
| 2         | 10           | 40     | 50%               | 67%             |

# Condition Coverage

- **Condition coverage** reveals how the variables in the conditional statement are evaluated (logical operands)
  - $(\text{executed operands} / \text{total operands}) * 100$

```
1 int main() {  
2     unsigned int x, y, a, b;  
3     if((x < y) && (a>b))  
4         return 0;  
5     else  
6         return -1;  
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| x<y | a>b | (x < y) && (a > b) |
|-----|-----|--------------------|
| 0   | 0   | 0                  |
| 0   | 1   | 0                  |
| 1   | 0   | 0                  |
| 1   | 1   | 1                  |

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| 0   | 1   | 0                |
| 1   | 0   | 0                |
| 1   | 1   | 1                |

| Input    | Condition | Outcome | Coverage |
|----------|-----------|---------|----------|
| x=3, y=4 | x<y       | TRUE    | 25%      |
| a=3, b=4 | a>b       | FALSE   | 25%      |



# Code coverage criteria

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- Statement coverage does not imply branch coverage; e.g. for

```
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    if (a<100) {b--};  
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```

Statement coverage needs 1 test case; branch coverage needs 2
- Other coverage criteria exists, e.g., **modified condition/decision coverage** (MCDC), which is used to test **avionics embedded software**

# Modified condition/decision coverage (MC/DC)

- MC/DC coverage is similar to condition coverage, but we must **test every condition in a decision independently** to reach full coverage
- MC/DC requires all of the below during testing:
  - We invoke each entry and exit point
  - We test every possible outcome for each decision
  - Each condition in a decision takes every possible outcome
  - We show each condition in a decision to affect the outcome of the decision independently

# Example of MC/DC

- Consider the following fragment of C code:

```
1 void foo(_Bool A, _Bool B, _Bool C) {  
2     if ( (A || B) && C ) {  
3         /* instructions */  
4     } else {  
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```

- Condition coverage:** A, B, and C should be evaluated at least one time “true” and one time “false”:

- A = true / B = true / C = true
- A = false / B = false / C = false

# Example of MC/DC

- Consider the following fragment of C code:

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```

- Decision coverage:** the condition ( (A || B) && C ) should also be evaluated at least one time to “true” and one time to “false”:

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# Example of MC/DC

- Consider the following fragment of C code:

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```

- MC/DC: each Boolean variable should be evaluated one time to “true” and one time to “false”, and this with affecting the decision's outcome



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```

- MC/DC: For a decision with  $n$  atomic boolean conditions, we have to find at least  $n+1$  tests

|                                  |   |                      |
|----------------------------------|---|----------------------|
| A = false / B = false / C = true | → | evaluates to "false" |
| A = false / B = true / C = true  | → | evaluates to "true"  |
| A = false / B = true / C = false | → | evaluates to "false" |
| A = true / B = false / C = true  | → | evaluates to "true"  |

[https://www.verifysoft.com/en\\_example\\_mcdc.html](https://www.verifysoft.com/en_example_mcdc.html)

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- There exist two essential and relatively independent aspects of **dynamic detection**:
  - How should one **monitor an execution** such that vulnerabilities are detected?
  - **How many and what program executions** (i.e., for what input values) should one monitor?

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  - detection can be performed by **monitoring for violations of that specification**
- For other vulnerabilities, or when monitoring for violations of a specification is too expensive, **approximative monitors** can be defined
  - In cases where a dynamic analysis is approximative, it can also generate **false positives** or **false negatives**
    - even though it operates on a concrete execution trace

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- **Assertions, pre-conditions, and post-conditions** can be compiled into the code to provide a monitor for API vulnerabilities at testing time
  - even if the cost of these compiled-in run-time checks can be too high to use them in production code

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  - even if the cost of these compiled-in run-time checks can be too high to use them in production code
- Monitoring for **race conditions is hard**, but some approaches for monitoring data races on shared memory cells exist
  - E.g., by monitoring whether all shared memory accesses follow a **consistent locking discipline**



# LTL – Linear Temporal Logic

Supported operators:

- $\square$  U:  $p$  holds **until**  $q$  holds

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- $\square$  X is not well defined for C
  - $\square$  no notion of “next”
- $\square$  C expressions used as atoms in LTL:

$\{\text{keyInput} == 1\} \rightarrow F \{\text{displayKeyUp}\}$

$(\{\text{keyInput} != 0\} \mid \{\text{intr}\}) \rightarrow G\{\text{numInputs} > 0\}$

*“event”: change of global variable used in LTL formula*

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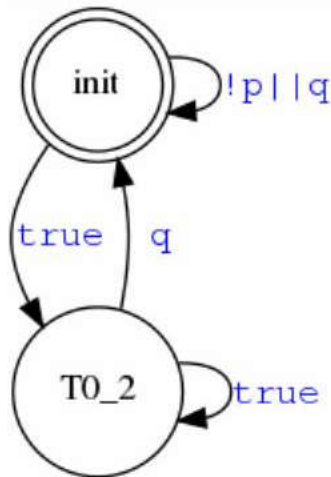


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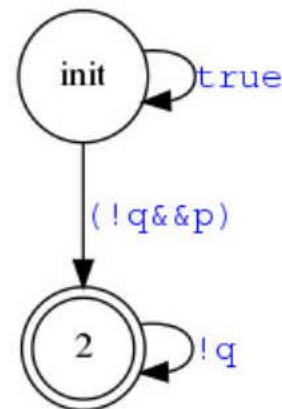
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$p \rightarrow Fq$



$!(p \rightarrow Fq)$

# Using BAs to check the program

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- Theory: check product of model and *never claim* for accepting state
  - SPIN: execute *never claim* in lockstep with model
  - ESBMC:
    - technically difficult to alternate between normal program and *never claim* program
    - instead: run *never claim* program as a monitor thread concurrently with other program thread(s)
- ⇒ no distinction between monitor thread and other threads

*Jeremy Morse, Lucas C. Cordeiro, Denis A. Nicole, Bernd Fischer: Context-Bounded Model Checking of LTL Properties for ANSI-C Software. SEFM 2011: 302-317*

# Ensuring soundness of monitor thread

Monitor thread will miss events:

- interleavings will exist where events are skipped (monitor thread scheduled out of sync)
- ⇒ can cause false violations of the property being verified
- ⇒ monitor thread must be run immediately after events

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Solution:

- ESBMC maintains (global) current count of events
- monitor checks it processes events one at a time (using assume statements)
  - ⇒ causes ESBMC to discard interleavings where monitor does not act on relevant state changes

# Example monitor thread

```
bool cexpr_0;    // “pressed”
bool cexpr_1;    // “charge > min”

typedef enum {T0_init, accept_S2 } lt12ba_state;
lt12ba_state state = T0_init;
unsigned int visited_states[2];
unsigned int trans_seen;
extern unsigned int trans_count;

void lt12ba_fsm(bool state_stats) {
    unsigned int choice;
    while(1) {
        choice = nondet_uint();
        /* Force a context switch */
        yield();
        atomic_begin();
        assume(trans_count <= trans_seen + 1);
        trans_seen = trans_count;
```



# Example monitor thread

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bool cexpr_0;  // “pressed”  
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typedef enum {T0_init, accept_S2 } tl2ba_state;  
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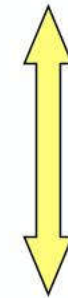


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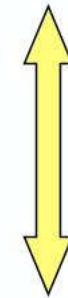
*nondeterminism*



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extern unsigned int trans_count;
```



*State transition  
and “event”  
counter setup*

```
void tl2ba_fsm(bool state_stats) {  
    unsigned int choice;  
    while(1) {  
        choice = nondet_uint();  
        /* Force a context switch */  
        yield();  
        atomic_begin();  
        assume(trans_count <= trans_seen + 1);  
        trans_seen = trans_count;
```

*nondeterminism*



*only interleave  
whole block*

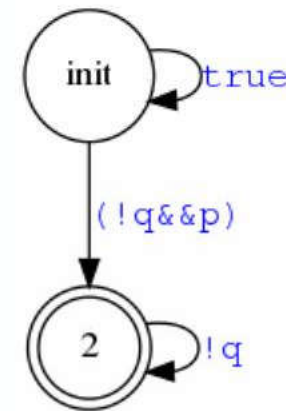


*reject unsafe  
interleavings*

# Example monitor thread

```
switch(state) {  
case T0_init:  
    if(choice == 0) {  
        assume((1));  
        state = T0_init;  
    } else if (choice == 1) {  
        assume((!cexpr_1 && cexpr_0));  
        state = accept_S2;  
    } else assume(0);  
    break;  
case accept_S2:  
    if(choice == 0) {  
        assume((!cexpr_1));  
        state = accept_S2;  
    } else assume(0);  
    break;  
}  
atomic_end();  
}
```

*automata transitions  
representing the  
formula  $!(p \rightarrow Fq)$*



# Infinite traces and BMC?

BMC forces program execution to eventually end

– but BA are defined over infinite traces...

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– but BA are defined over infinite traces...

Solution:

- follow SPINs stuttering acceptance approach:  
pretend final state extends infinitely
- re-run monitor thread after program termination,  
with enough loop iterations to pass through each state twice
- if an accepting state is visited at least twice while stuttering,  
BA accepts extended trace
  - LTL property violation found

# Intended learning outcomes

- Understand **dynamic detection techniques** to identify security vulnerabilities
- Generate **executions of the program** along paths that will lead to the **discovery of new vulnerabilities**
- Explain **black-box fuzzing**: grammar-based and **mutation-based fuzzing**
- Explain **white-box fuzzing**: **dynamic symbolic execution**

# Generating relevant executions

**Challenge:** generate executions of the program along paths that will lead to the discovery of new vulnerabilities



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# Generating relevant executions

**Challenge:** generate executions of the program along paths that will lead to the discovery of new vulnerabilities

- This problem is an instance of the general problem in **software testing**
  - Systematically **select appropriate inputs** for a program under test
  - These techniques are often described by the umbrella term **fuzz testing** or **fuzzing**

# Fuzzing

**Fuzzing is a highly effective, mostly automated, security testing technique**

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**Fuzzing is a highly effective, mostly automated, security testing technique**

- **Basic idea:** generate random inputs and check whether an application crashes
  - We are not testing functional correctness (compliance)
- **Original fuzzing:** generate long inputs and check whether the system crashes
  - What kind of bug would such a segfault signal?
    - Memory access violation
  - Why would inputs ideally be very long?
    - To make it likely that buffer overruns cross segment boundaries so that the OS triggers a fault

# Simple fuzzing ideas

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# Simple fuzzing ideas

- What inputs would you use for fuzzing?
  - **very long** or completely **blank strings**
  - **min/max** values of integers, or only zero and negative values
  - depending on what you are fuzzing, include **unique values, characters** or **keywords** likely to trigger bugs:
    - nulls, newlines, or end-of-file characters
    - format string characters **%s %x %n**
    - semi-colons, slashes and backslashes, quotes
    - application-specific keywords **halt, DROP TABLES, ...**

# Illustrative Example

- Is this circular buffer implementation correct?

```
#define BUFFER_MAX 10
static char buffer[BUFFER_MAX];
int first, next, buffer_size;
void initLog(int max) {
    buffer_size = max;
    first = next = 0;
}
int removeLogElem(void) {
    first++;
    return buffer[first-1];
}
void insertLogElem(int b) {
    if (next < buffer_size) {
        buffer[next] = b;
        next = (next+1)%buffer_size;
    }
}
```

# Illustrative Example

- Does this test case expose some error?

```
void testCircularBuffer(void) {  
    int senData[] = {1, -128, 98, 88, 59, 1,  
-128, 90, 0, -37};  
    int i;  
    initLog(5);  
    for(i=0; i<10; i++)  
        insertLogElem(senData[i]);  
    for(i=5; i<10; i++)  
        assert(senData[i], removeLogElem());  
}
```

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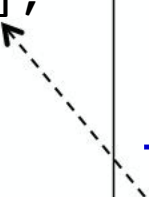
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        next = (next+1)%buffer_size;
    }
}
```

The buffer array is of type char and size BUFFER\_MAX

Increment first without checking the array bound: **buffer overflow**

Assign an integer to a char variable: **typecast overflow**



# Pros & cons of fuzzing

- Minimal effort:
  - the test cases are automatically generated, and test oracle is merely looking for crashes
- Fuzzing of a C/C++ binary can quickly give a good picture of the robustness of the code

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- Minimal effort:
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  - Fuzzing of a C/C++ binary can quickly give a good picture of the robustness of the code
- 
- Fuzzers do not find all bugs
  - Crashes may be hard to analyze, but a crash is a **true positive** that something is wrong!
  - For programs that take **complex inputs**, more work will be needed to get **reasonable code coverage** and **hit unusual test cases**
    - Leads to various studies on “**smarter**” fuzzers

# Intended learning outcomes

- Understand **dynamic detection techniques** to identify security vulnerabilities
- Generate **executions of the program** along paths that will lead to the **discovery of new vulnerabilities**
- Explain **black-box fuzzing: grammar-based and mutation-based fuzzing**
- Explain **white-box fuzzing: dynamic symbolic execution**

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# Black-box fuzzing

**The generation of values depends on the program input/output behaviour, and not on its internal structure**

- ① **Random testing:** input values are randomly sampled from the appropriate value domain
- ② **Grammar-based fuzzing:** a model of the expected format of input values is taken into account during the generation of input values
- ③ **Mutation-based fuzzing:** the fuzzer is provided with typical input values; it generates new input values by performing small mutations on the provided input

# Random Testing

- Random testing produces **random, independent inputs**, to test software

```
int sig_invert(int signal) {  
    if (signal < 0)  
        return signal; // bug  
    else  
        return signal;  
}
```



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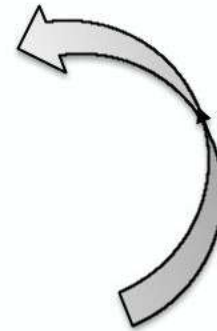
```
int sig_invert(int signal) {  
    if (signal < 0)  
        return signal; // bug  
    else  
        return signal;  
}
```

```
void testSig_Inverter(int n) {  
    for (int i=0; i<n; i++) {  
        int x = rand();  
        int result = sig_invert(x);  
        assert(result >= 0);  
    }  
}
```

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```
int sig_invert(int signal) {  
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}
```



the random tests  
could be {827989654,  
328082218, 1487316077,  
611655059, 82358424}

```
void testSig_Inverter(int n) {  
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```

# Replace random by non-deterministic variable

- Use a model checker to produce an **input that triggers the property violation**

```
int nondet_int();
void testSig_Inverter(int n) {
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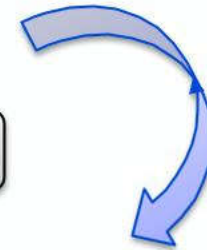
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        int result = sig_invert(x);  
        assert(result >= 0);  
    }  
}
```

\$esbmc random-testing.c



State 9 file file.c line 16 function testSig\_Inverter thread 0

-----  
x = -2147483648

...

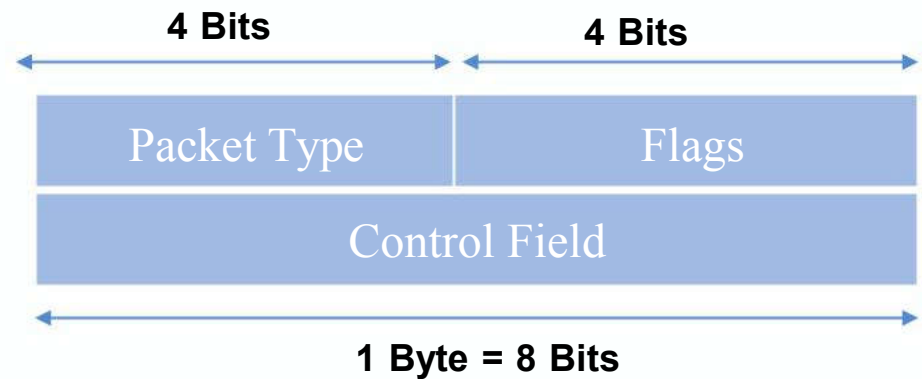
Violated property:

...

!((\_Bool)((signed long int)(!(result >= 0))))

# Grammar-based fuzzing

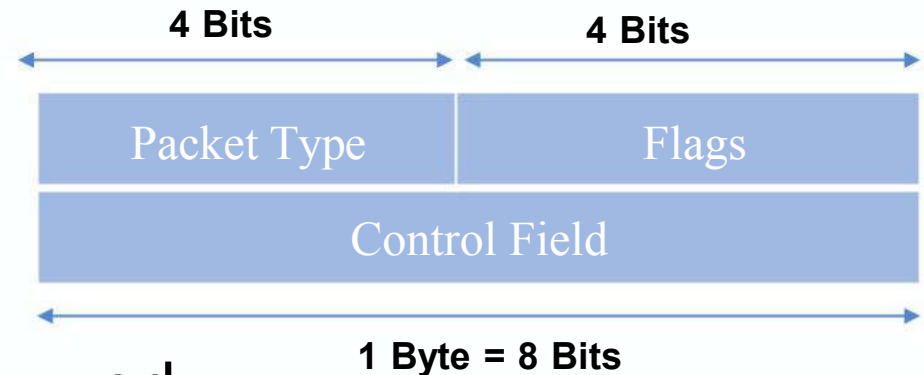
- For communication protocols, a **grammar-based fuzzer** generate files or data packets, which are:
  - Slightly malformed
  - Hit corner cases in the spec
  - **Grammar** defining legal input or a **data format specification**



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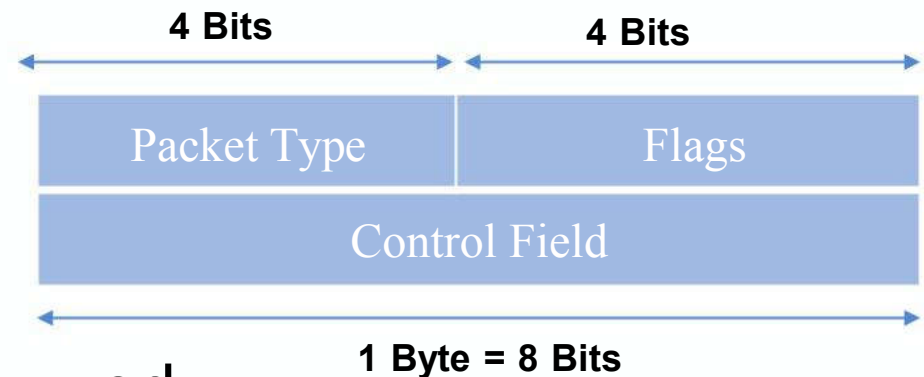
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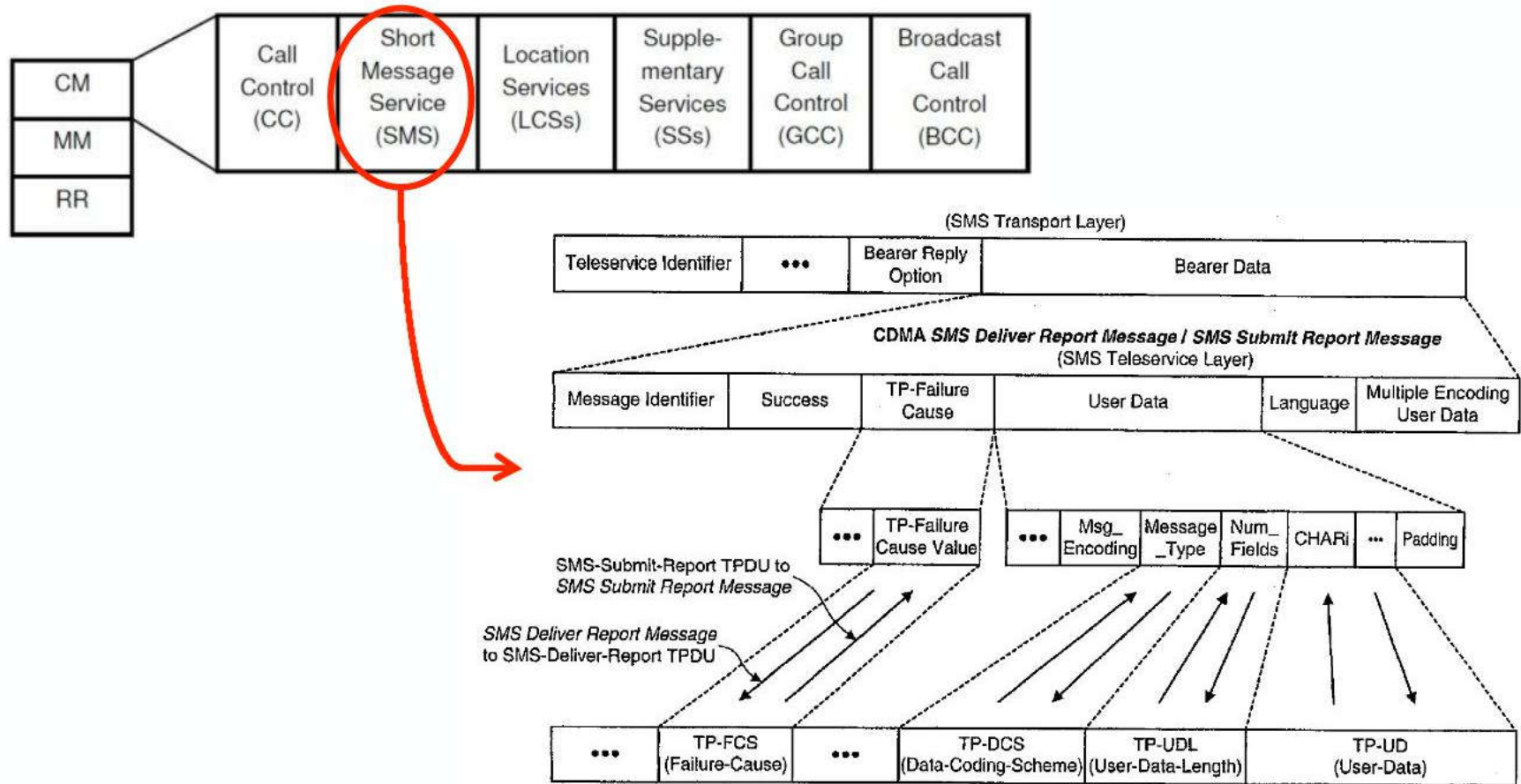


- Typical things that can be fuzzed:
  - many/all possible value for specific fields (undefined values)
  - incorrect lengths, lengths that are zero, or payloads that are too short/long
- Tools for building such fuzzers: SNOOZE, SPIKE, Peach, Sulley, antiparser, Netzob, ...



# Example: Grammar-based Fuzzing of GSM

GSM is an extremely rich and complicated protocol



*Fabian van den Broek, Brinio Hond, Arturo Cedillo Torres: Security Testing of GSM Implementations. ESSoS 2014: 179-195*

# SMS Message Fields

| Field                      | size                   |
|----------------------------|------------------------|
| Message Type Indicator     | 2 bit                  |
| Reject Duplicates          | 1 bit                  |
| Validity Period Format     | 2 bit                  |
| User Data Header Indicator | 1 bit                  |
| Reply Path                 | 1 bit                  |
| Message Reference          | integer                |
| Destination Address        | 2-12 byte              |
| Protocol Identifier        | 1 byte                 |
| Data Coding Scheme (CDS)   | 1 byte                 |
| Validity Period            | 1 byte/7 bytes         |
| User Data Length (UDL)     | integer                |
| User Data                  | depends on CDS and UDL |

# Example: GSM protocol fuzzing

- We can use a **Universal Software Radio Peripheral (USRP)**
  - Most USRPs connect to a host computer through a high-speed link
    - the host-based software uses to control the USRP hardware and transmit/receive data
  - With open-source cell tower software (OpenBTS) to fuzz any phone



# Example: GSM protocol fuzzing

- Fuzzing SMS layer of GSM reveals unexpected behaviour in GSM standard and phones



# Example: GSM protocol fuzzing

- Fuzzing SMS layer of GSM reveals unexpected behaviour in GSM standard and phones



possibility to  
receive faxes?

**Only way to get rid if this icon; reboot the phone**

# Example: GSM protocol fuzzing

- Malformed SMS text messages
  - show **raw memory** instead of the **text message**

(a) Showing garbage



(b) Showing the name of a wallpaper and two games



# Mutation-based fuzzing:

## Fuzzing OCPP

- The **Open Charge Point Protocol** (OCPP) is an application protocol
  - communication between Electric vehicle (EV) charging stations and a central management system
- OCPP can use XML or JSON messages

Example message in JSON format

```
{  "location":  NijmegenMercator2156
  "retries":   5,
  "retryInterval":  30,
  "startTime":   "2018-10-27T19:10:11",
  "stopTime":    "2018-10-27T22:10:11"   }
```



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  - ③ **well-formed OCPP**: can be used for a simple test oracle
    - Malformed messages (type 1 & 2) should generate a generic error response
    - Well-formed messages (type 3) should not
    - The application should never crash

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    - Malformed messages (type 1 & 2) should generate a generic error response
    - Well-formed messages (type 3) should not
    - The application should never crash
- Note: this does not require any understanding of the protocol semantics yet!
  - Figuring out correct responses to type 3 would need

# Evolutionary Fuzzing with AFL

- **Grammar-based fuzzer:**
  - Significant work to write code to fuzz, even if we use tools to generate this code based on some grammar
- **Mutation-based fuzzer:**
  - The chance that random changes in inputs hit unusual cases is small

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- **AFL** (American Fuzzy Lop) takes an evolutionary approach to learn mutations based on measuring code coverage

- basic idea: if a mutation of the input triggers a new path through the code, then it is an exciting mutation; otherwise, the mutation is discarded
- Produce random mutations of the input and observe their effect on code coverage, **AFL** can learn what interesting inputs are

# The Fuzzing Process of AFL

1. Start with sample seed inputs
2. Mutate seed inputs to generate mutants
3. Collect code coverage (CFG edges) information
4. Save as new seeds if coverage increases
5. Repeat from step 2

# American Fuzzy Lop

- Support programs written in **C/C++/Objective C** and variants for **Python/Go/Rust/OCaml**

<https://lcamtuf.coredump.cx/afl/>

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- Code coverage represented as a 64KB bitmap, where control flow jumps are mapped to changes in this bitmap
  - different executions could lead to the same bitmap, but the chance is small
- Mutation strategies: bit flips, incrementing/decrementing integers, using pre-defined integer values (e.g., 0, -1, MAX\_INT,...), deleting/combining/zeroing input blocks

<https://lcamtuf.coredump.cx/afl/>

# AFL's instrumentation of compiled code

- Code is injected at every branch point in the code

```
cur_location =  
<COMPILE_TIME_RANDOM_FOR_THIS_CODE_BLOCK>;  
shared_mem[cur_location ^  
prev_location]++;
```

Bitwise exclusive OR

```
prev_location = cur_location >> 1;
```

where **shared\_mem** is a 64 KB memory region

```
cur_location = 5;
```

```
prev_location = 3;
```

0101 (decimal 5)  
XOR 0011 (decimal 3)  
= 0110 (decimal 6)

*cur\_location* ^  
*prev\_location*

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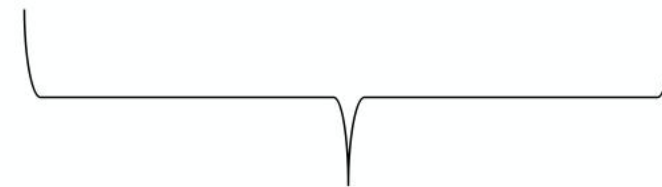
```
cur_location = <COMPILE_TIME_RANDOM_FOR_THIS_CODE_BLOCK>;
```

```
shared_mem[cur_location ^ prev_location]++;
```

```
prev_location = cur_location >> Shift right  
1;
```

where **shared\_mem** is a 64 KB memory region

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```



0101 (decimal 5)  
shift 0010 (decimal 2)

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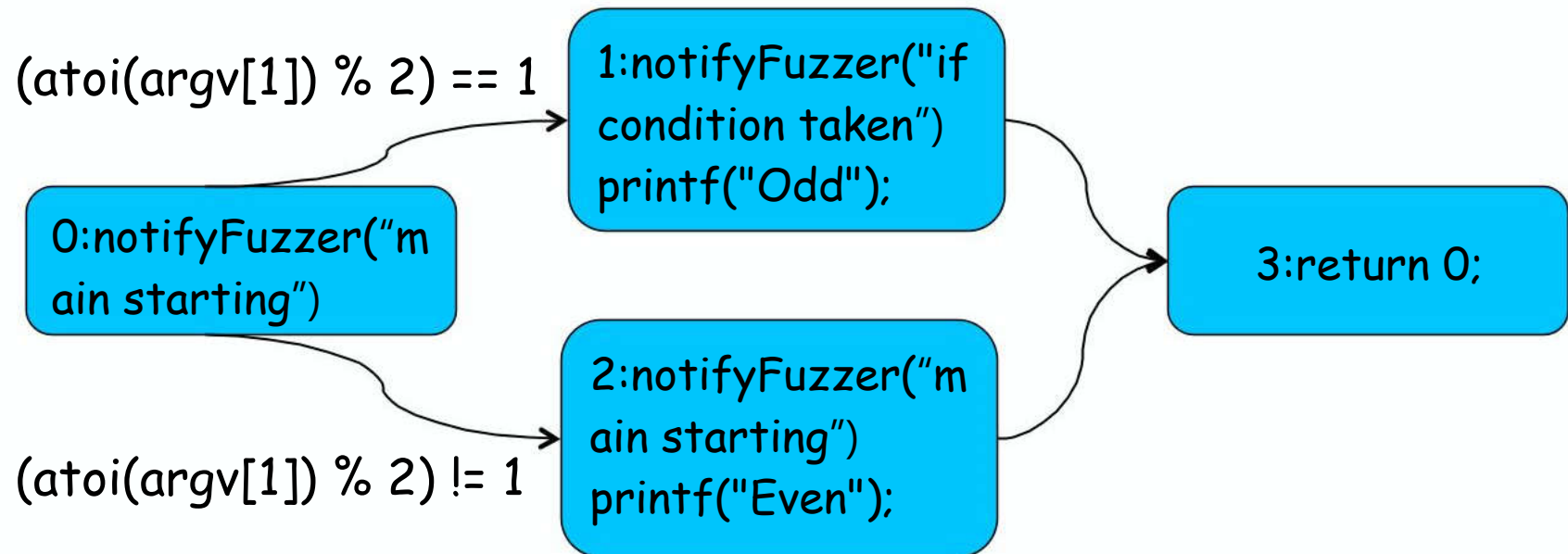
where **shared\_mem** is a 64 KB memory region

- Intuition: for every jump from **src** to **dest** in the code a different byte in **shared\_mem** is changed
  - This byte is determined by the compile-time randoms inserted at source and destination

# Example of AFL instrumentation

- Consider a code fragment that determines a parameter to be **even** or **odd**

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
int main(int argc, char *argv[]) {
    ((atoi(argv[1]) % 2) == 1) ? printf("Odd") : printf("Even");
    return 0;
}
```

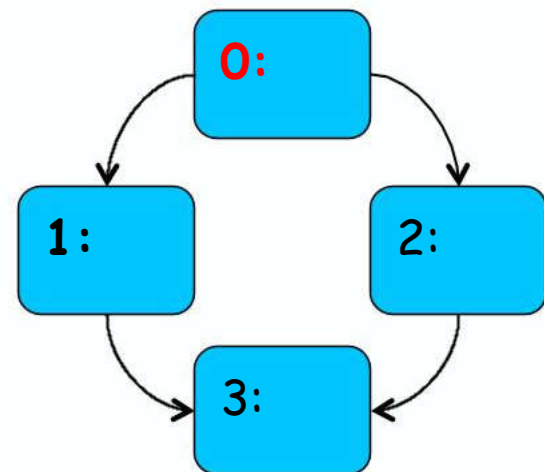


# Example of AFL instrumentation

- AFL assigns a **random compile time** constant to **each basic block** and uses a 64kB array to **trace the execution flow** using the following logic

```
cur_location = <COMPILE_TIME_RANDOM>;  
shared_mem[cur_location ^ prev_location]++;  
prev_location = cur_location >> 1;
```

```
prev_location: 0  
cur_location: 0  
cur_location ^ prev_location: 0  
shared_mem[0]: 1  
prev_location: 0
```

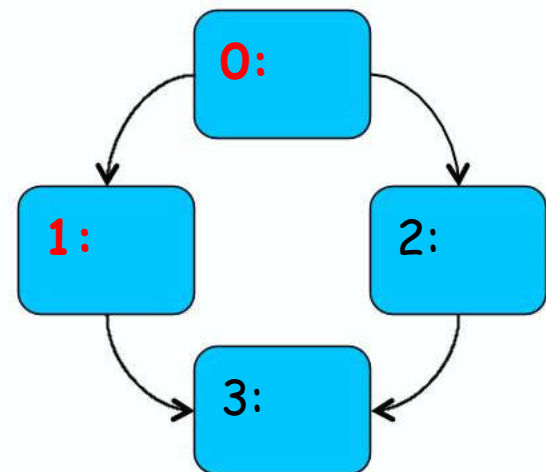


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```
prev_location: 0  
cur_location: 1  
cur_location ^ prev_location: 1  
shared_mem[1]: 1  
prev_location: 0
```



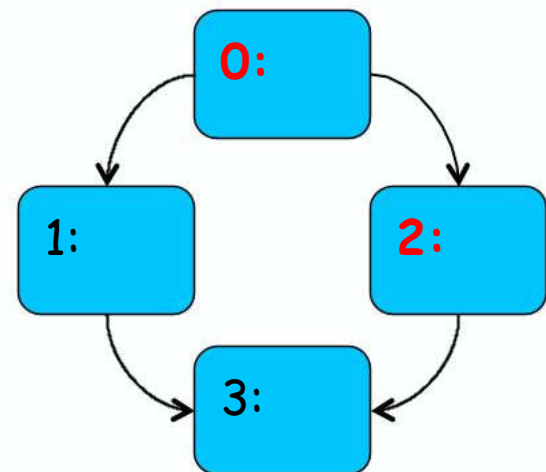


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prev_location = cur_location >> 1;
```

```
prev_location: 0  
cur_location: 2  
cur_location ^ prev_location: 2  
shared_mem[2]: 1  
prev_location: 1
```

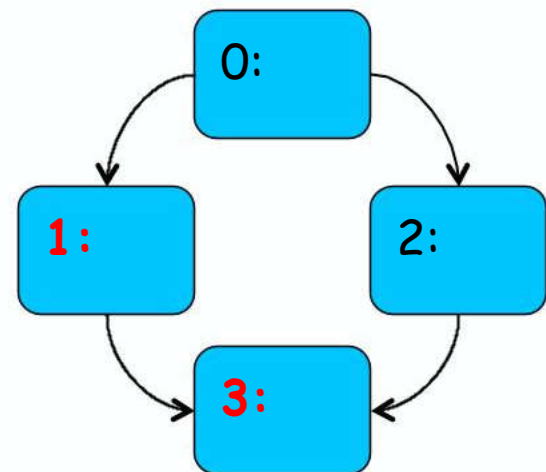


# Example of AFL instrumentation

- AFL assigns a **random compile time** constant to **each basic block** and uses a 64kB array to **trace the execution flow** using the following logic

```
cur_location = <COMPILE_TIME_RANDOM>;  
shared_mem[cur_location ^ prev_location]++;  
prev_location = cur_location >> 1;
```

```
prev_location: 1  
cur_location: 3  
cur_location ^ prev_location: 2  
shared_mem[2]: 2  
prev_location: 1
```

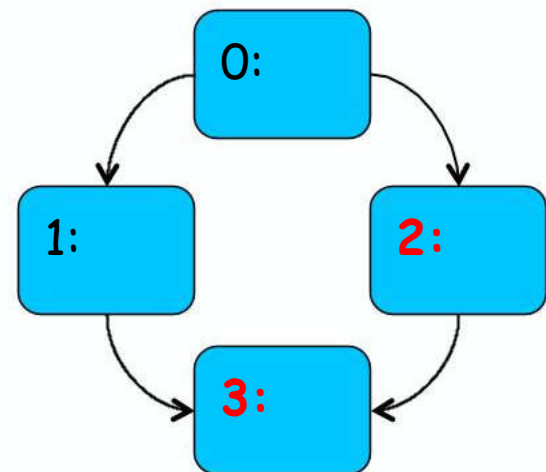


# Example of AFL instrumentation

- AFL assigns a **random compile time** constant to **each basic block** and uses a 64kB array to **trace the execution flow** using the following logic

```
cur_location = <COMPILE_TIME_RANDOM>;  
shared_mem[cur_location ^ prev_location]++;  
prev_location = cur_location >> 1;
```

```
prev_location: 2  
cur_location: 3  
cur_location ^ prev_location: 1  
shared_mem[1]: 2  
prev_location: 1
```



# Intended learning outcomes

- Understand **dynamic detection techniques** to identify security vulnerabilities
- Generate **executions of the program** along paths that will lead to the **discovery of new vulnerabilities**
- Explain **black-box fuzzing: grammar-based and mutation-based fuzzing**
- Explain **white-box fuzzing: dynamic symbolic execution**

# **White-box fuzzing**

**The internal structure of the program is analysed to assist in the generation of appropriate input values**

# White-box fuzzing

The internal structure of the program is analysed to assist in the generation of appropriate input values

- The primary systematic white-box fuzzing technique is a **dynamic symbolic execution**
  - Executes a program with concrete input values and builds at the same time a **path condition**
    - o An expression that specifies the constraints on those input values that have to be fulfilled to take this specific execution path

# White-box fuzzing

The internal structure of the program is analysed to assist in the generation of appropriate input values

- The primary systematic white-box fuzzing technique is a **dynamic symbolic execution**
  - Executes a program with concrete input values and builds at the same time a **path condition**
    - An expression that specifies the constraints on those input values that have to be fulfilled to take this specific execution path
  - Solve input values that do not satisfy the path condition of the current execution
    - the fuzzer can make sure that these input values will drive the program to a different execution path, thus **improving coverage**

# Coverage Test Generation for Security

```
x = input();  
if (x >= 10)  
{  
    if (x < 100)  
        vulnerable_code();  
    else  
        func_a();  
}  
else  
    func_b();
```



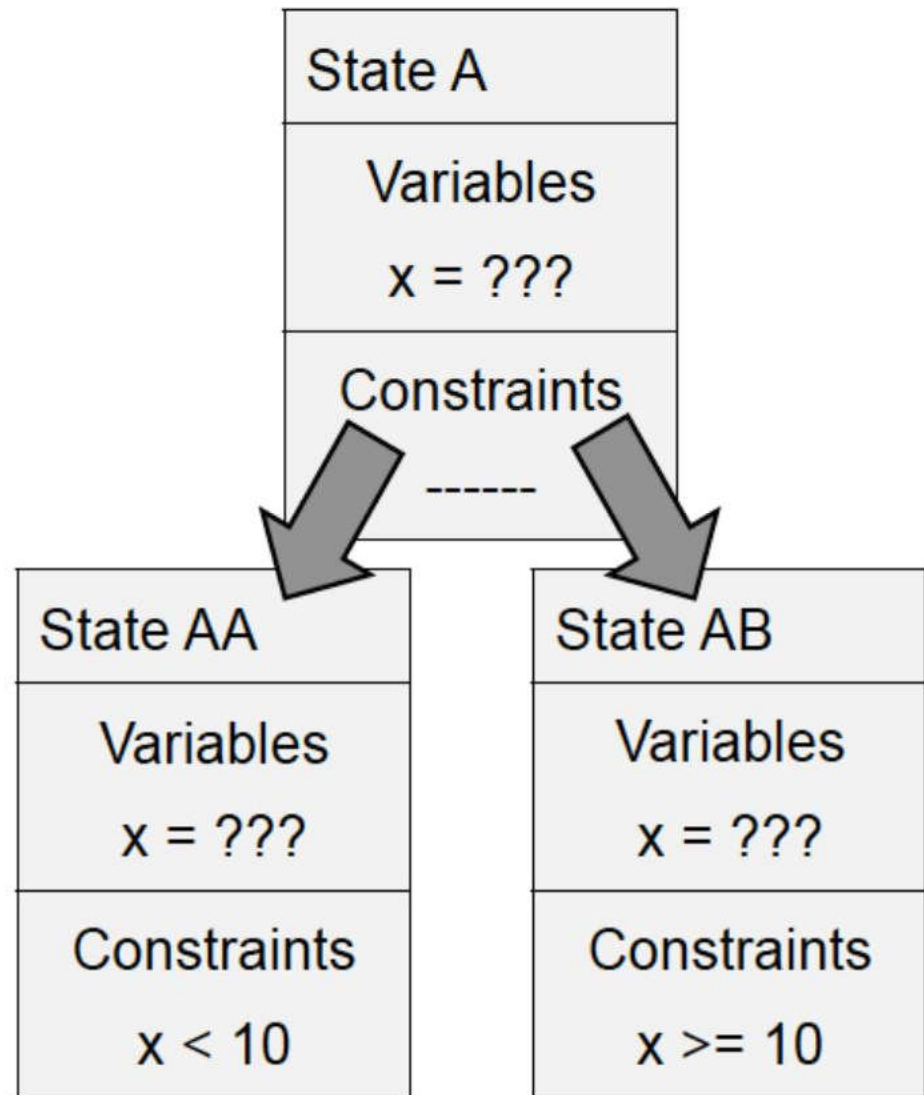
# Coverage Test Generation for Security

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    if (x < 100)  
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    else  
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}  
else  
    func_b();
```

|                      |
|----------------------|
| State A              |
| Variables<br>x = ??? |
| Constraints<br>----- |

# Coverage Test Generation for Security

```
x = input();  
if (x >= 10)  
{  
  if (x < 100)  
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else  
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```



# Coverage Test Generation for Security

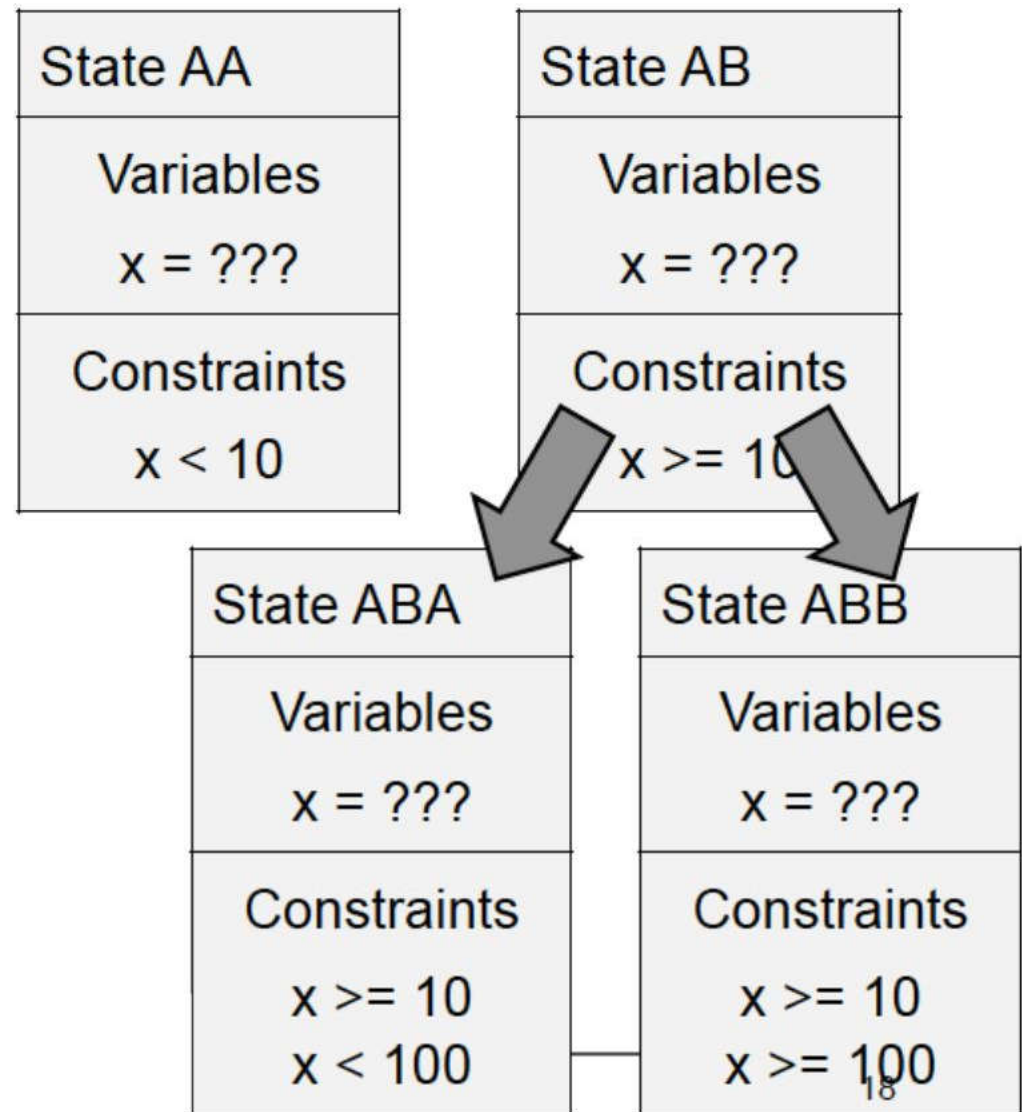
```
x = input();  
if (x >= 10)  
{  
  if (x < 100)  
    vulnerable_code();  
  else  
    func_a();  
}  
else  
  func_b();
```

| State AA              |
|-----------------------|
| Variables<br>x = ???  |
| Constraints<br>x < 10 |

| State AB               |
|------------------------|
| Variables<br>x = ???   |
| Constraints<br>x >= 10 |

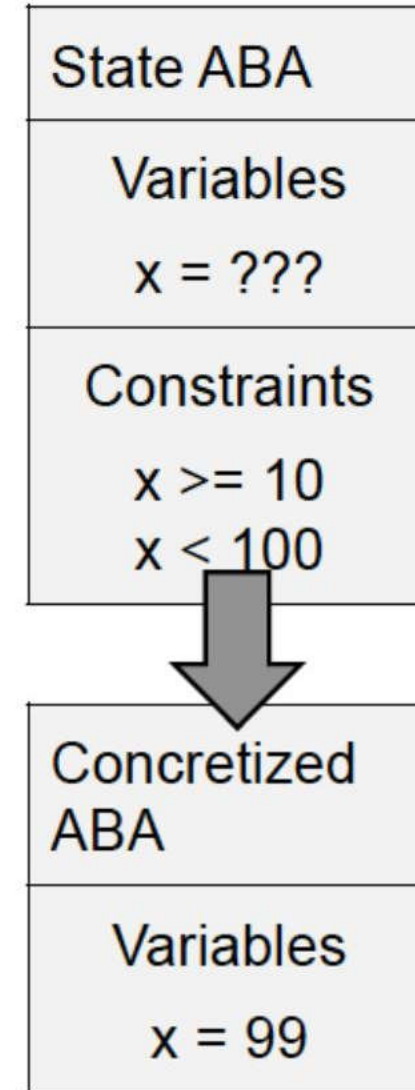
# Coverage Test Generation for Security

```
x = input();  
if (x >= 10)  
{  
  if (x < 100)  
    vulnerable_code();  
  else  
    func_a();  
}  
else  
  func_b();
```



# Coverage Test Generation for Security

```
x = input();  
if (x >= 10)  
{  
  if (x < 100)  
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```



# White-box Fuzzing

- Combine fuzz testing with **dynamic test generation**

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# White-box Fuzzing

- Combine fuzz testing with **dynamic test generation**
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  - **Synthesize new inputs**

# White-box Fuzzing

- Combine fuzz testing with **dynamic test generation**
  - **Run the code** with some initial input
  - **Collect constraints on input** with symbolic execution
  - **Generate new constraints**
  - **Solve constraints** with constraint solver
  - **Synthesize new inputs**
  - Leverages **Directed Automated Random Testing (DART)** ( [Godefroid-Klarlund-Sen-05,...])
  - See also previous talk on **EXE** [Cadar-Engler-05, Cadar-Ganesh-Pawlowski-Engler-Dill-06, Dunbar-Cadar-Pawlowski-Engler-08,...]

# Dynamic Test Generation

```
void top(char
input[4])

    int cnt =
    if (input[0] == 'b') cnt++;
    if (input[1] == 'a') cnt++;
    if (input[2] == 'd') cnt++;
    if (input[3] == '!') cnt++;
    if (cnt >= 3) crash();
}
```

input =  
"good"

# Dynamic Test Generation

```
void top(char  
input[4])
```

```
    int cnt =
```

```
    if (input[0] == 'b') cnt++;
```

```
    if (input[1] == 'a') cnt++;
```

```
    if (input[2] == 'd') cnt++;
```

```
    if (input[3] == '!') cnt++;
```

```
    if (cnt >= 3) crash();
```

```
}
```

```
input =  
    "good"
```

```
I0 != 'b'
```

```
I1 != 'a'
```

```
I2 != 'd'
```

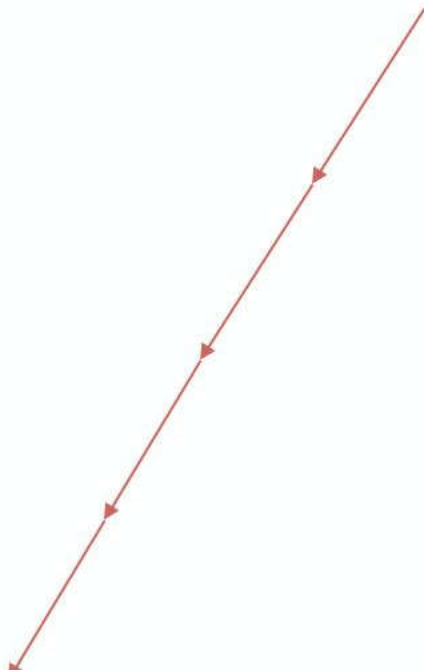
```
I3 != '!'
```

Collect constraints from trace

Create new constraints

Solve new constraints → new input.

# Depth-First Search



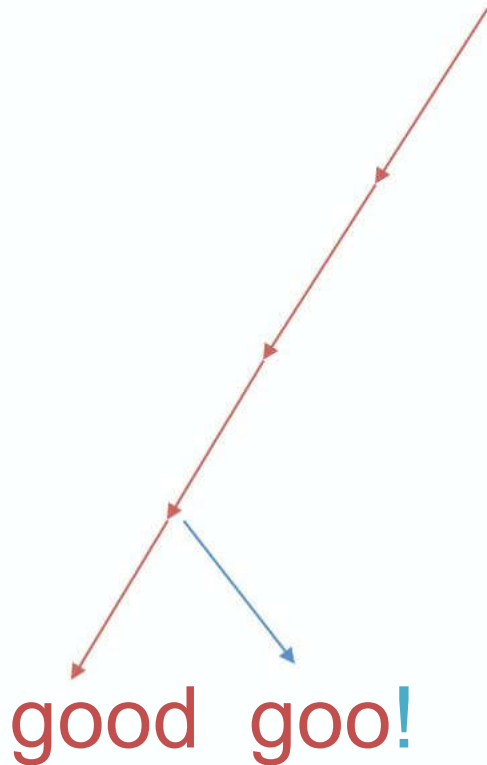
good

```
void top(char
input[4])
{  int  cnt  =
    if  (input[0]  ==  'b')  cnt++; I0  != 'b'
    if  (input[1]  ==  'a')  cnt++; I1  != 'a'
    if  (input[2]  ==  'd')  cnt++; I2  != 'd'
    if  (input[3]  ==  '!' ) cnt++; I3  != '!'

    if  (cnt  >=  3)  crash();

}
```

# Depth-First Search



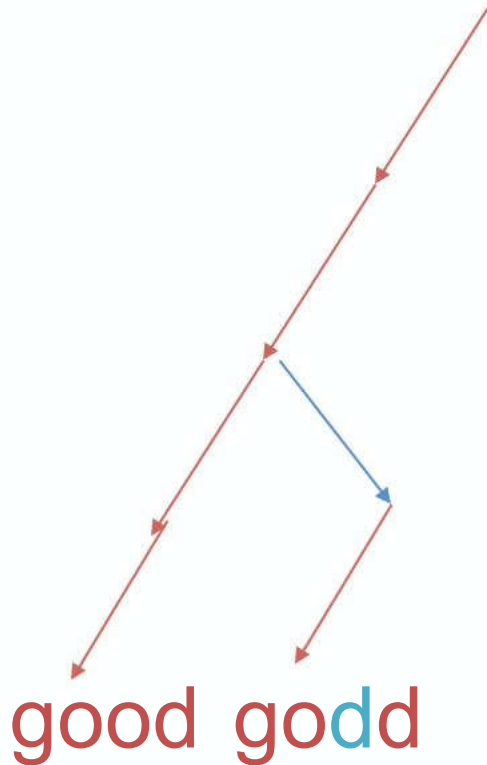
```
void top(char
input[4])
{  int  cnt  =
    if  (input[0]  ==  'b')  cnt++; I0  != 'b'
    if  (input[1]  ==  'a')  cnt++; I1  != 'a'
    if  (input[2]  ==  'd')  cnt++; I2  != 'd'
    if  (input[3]  ==  '!')  cnt++; I3  == '!'

    if  (cnt  >=  3)  crash();

}
```



# Depth-First Search



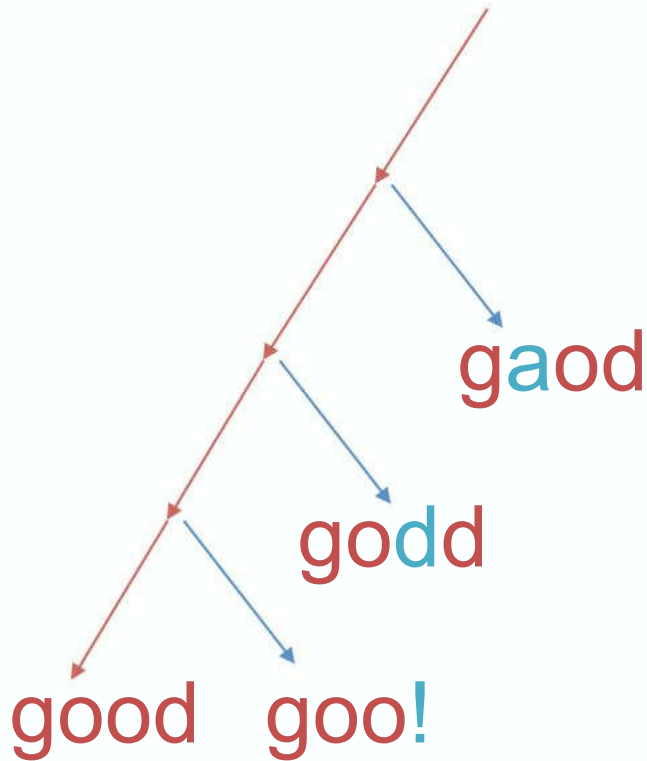
```
void top(char
input[4])

{   int   cnt   =
    0
    if   (input[0]   ==   'b')   cnt++; I0   != 'b'
    if   (input[1]   ==   'a')   cnt++; I1   != 'a'
    if   (input[2]   ==   'd')   cnt++; I2   == 'd'
    if   (input[3]   ==   '!')   cnt++; I3   != '!'

    if   (cnt   >=   3)   crash();

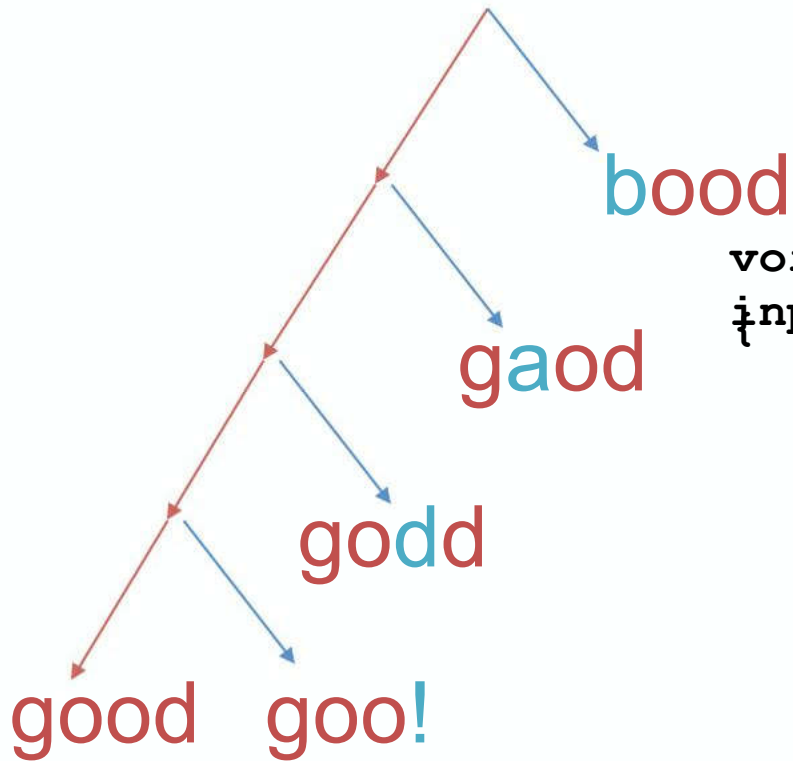
}
```

# Depth-First Search



```
void top(char
input[4])
{
    int cnt =
    if (input[0] == 'b') cnt++;  $I_0 \neq 'b'$ 
    if (input[1] == 'a') cnt++;  $I_1 == 'a'$ 
    if (input[2] == 'd') cnt++;  $I_2 \neq 'd'$ 
    if (input[3] == '!') cnt++;  $I_3 \neq '!'$ 
    if (cnt >= 3) crash();
}
```

# Depth-First Search

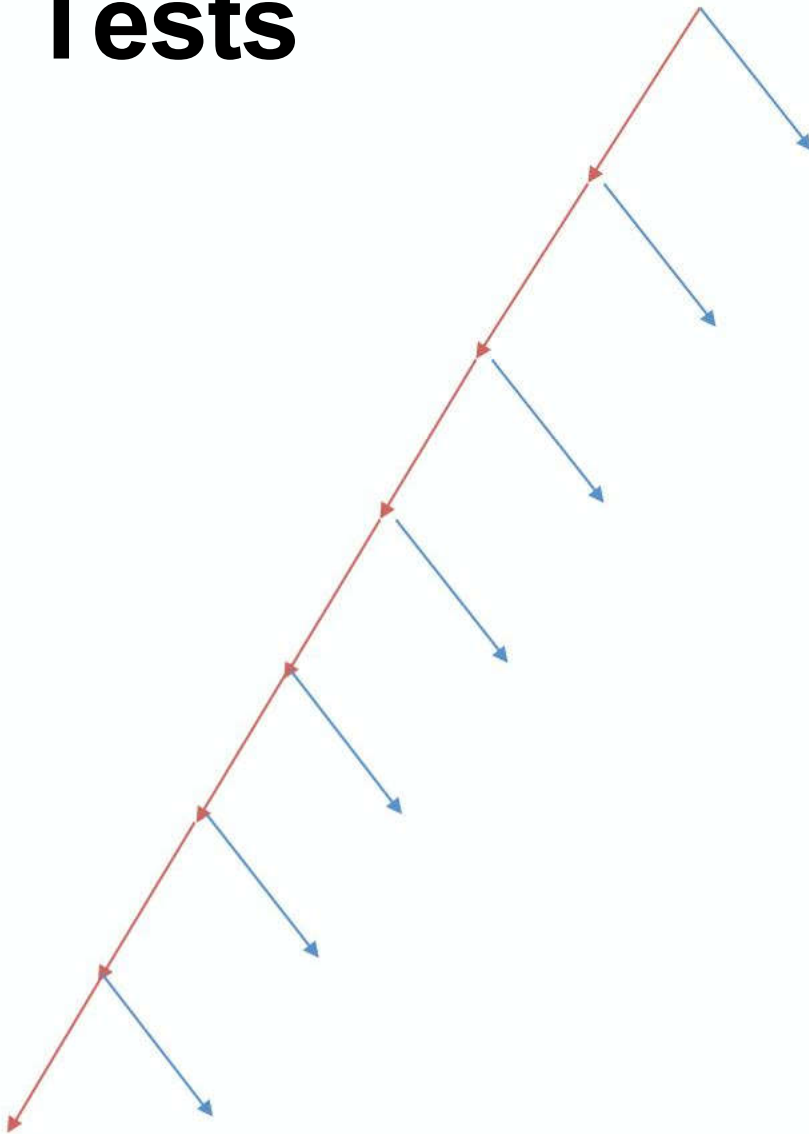


```
void top(char  
input[4])
```

```
int cnt =  
if (input[0] == 'b') cnt++; I0 == 'b'  
if (input[1] == 'a') cnt++; I1 != 'a'  
if (input[2] == 'd') cnt++; I2 != 'd'  
if (input[3] == '!') cnt++; I3 != '!'  
if (cnt >= 3) crash();
```

```
}
```

# Key Idea: One Trace, Many Tests

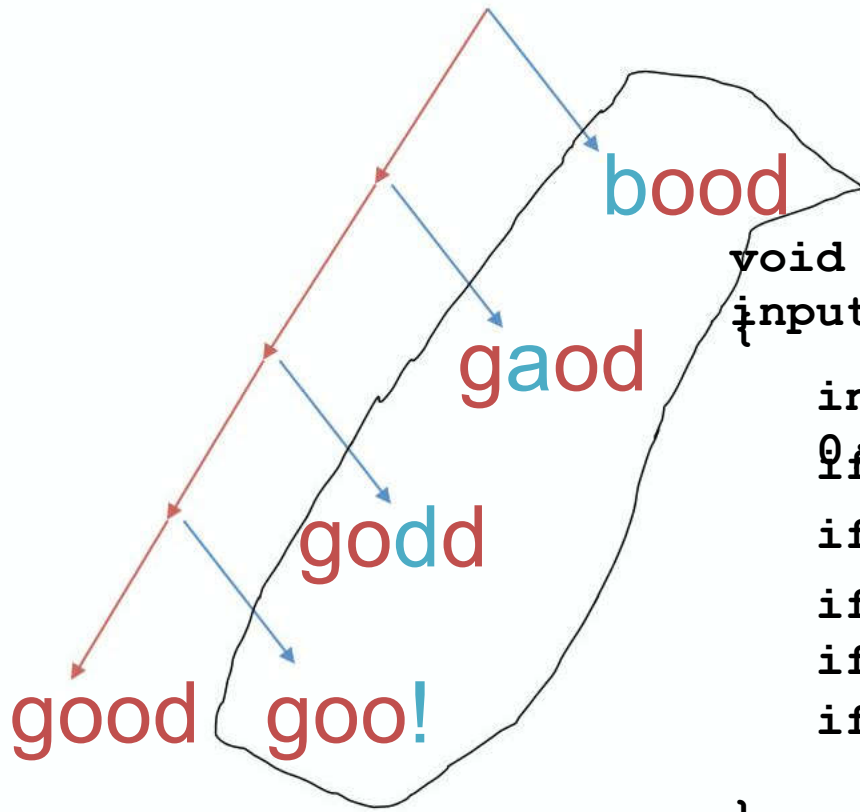


Office 2007 application:  
Time to **gather constraints**: 25m30s  
**Tainted branches/trace**: ~1000

Time per branch to  
**solve**,  
**generate new test**,  
**check for crashes**: ~1s

Therefore, solve+check **all** branches  
for each trace!

# Generational Search



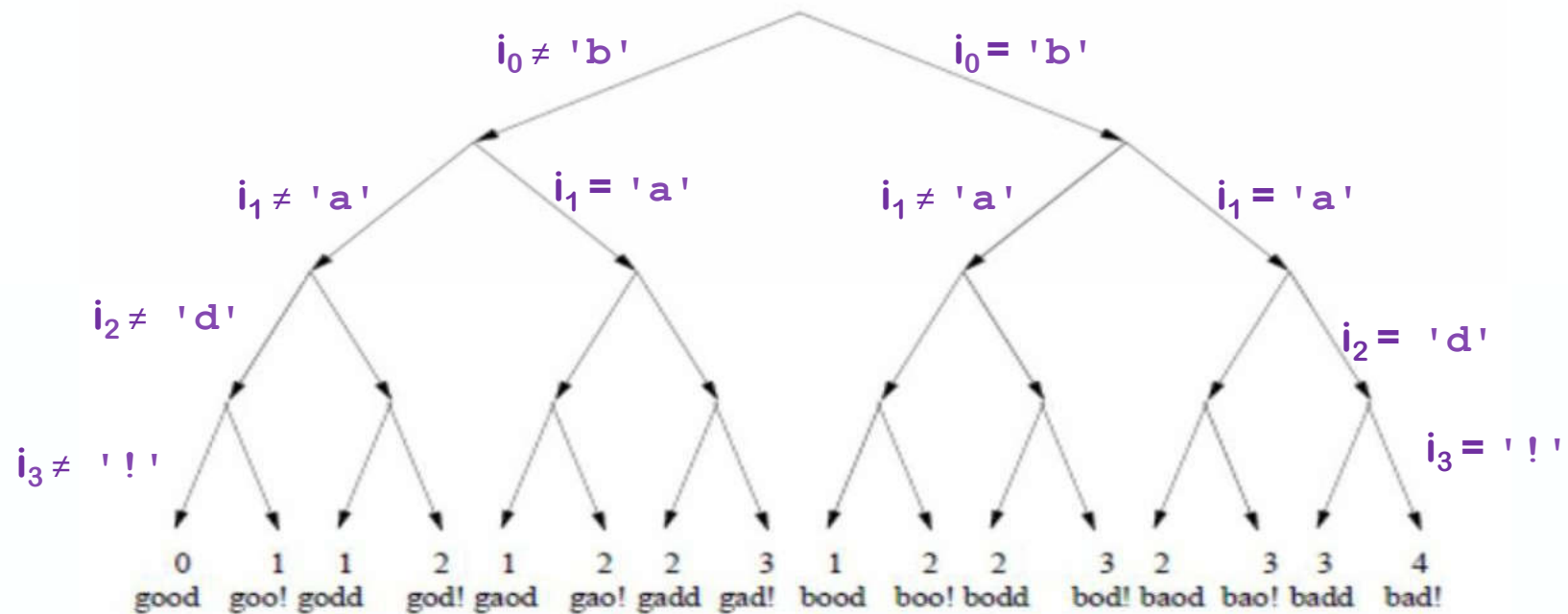
```
void top(char  
input[4])  
{
```

```
    int cnt =  
    if (input[0] == 'b') cnt++; I0 == 'b'  
    if (input[1] == 'a') cnt++; I1 == 'a'  
    if (input[2] == 'd') cnt++; I2 == 'd'  
    if (input[3] == '!') cnt++; I3 == '!'  
    if (cnt >= 3) crash();
```

```
}
```

# Search space for interesting inputs

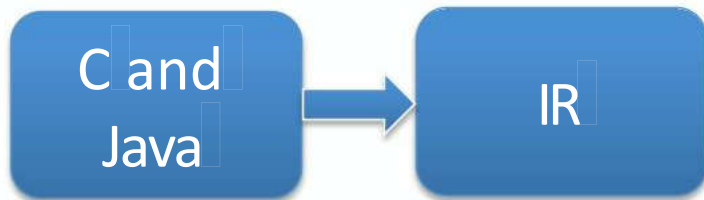
Based on this one execution, combining all these constraints now yields 16 test cases



Note: the initial execution with the input '**good**' was not very interesting, but these others are

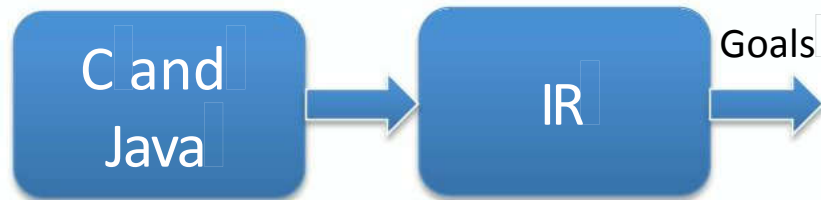
# BMC for Coverage Test Generation

- Translate the program to an **intermediate representation (IR)**



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- Add goals indicating the **coverage**
  - *location, branch, decision, condition and path*





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- Add goals indicating the **coverage**
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- **Symbolically** execute IR to produce an SSA program



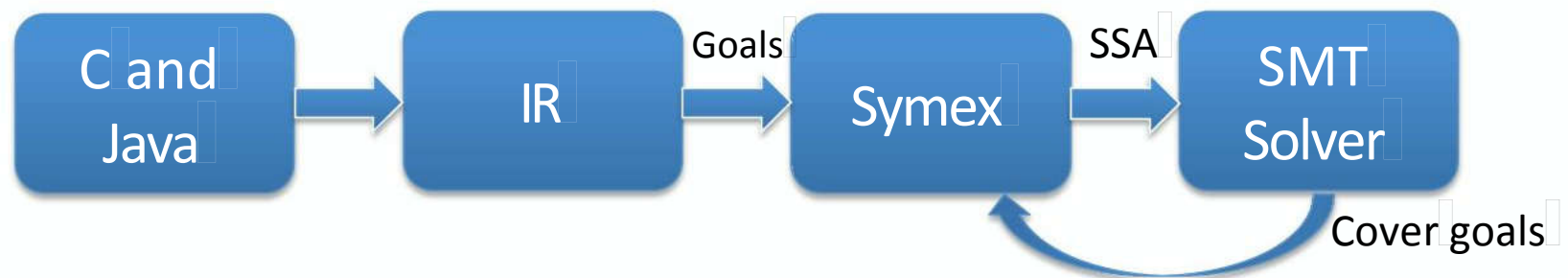
# BMC for Coverage Test Generation

- Translate the program to an **intermediate representation** (IR)
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- Translate the resulting SSA program into a **logical formula**



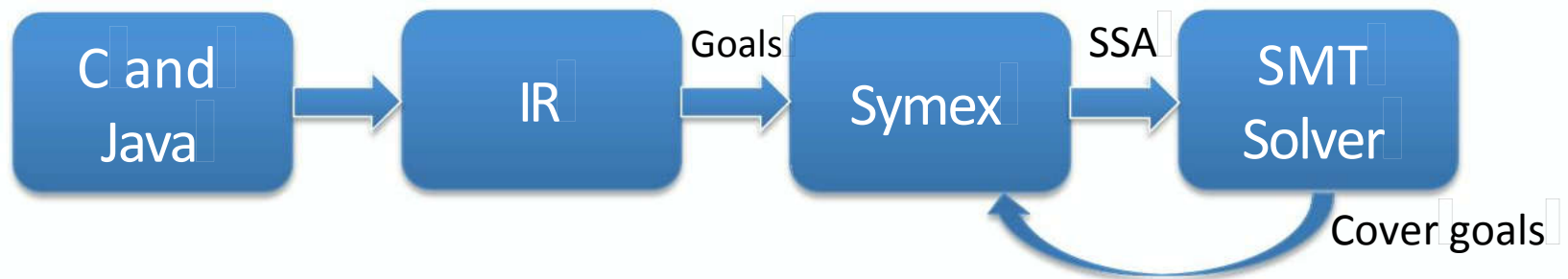
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- Translate the program to an **intermediate representation** (IR)
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- Solve the formula iteratively to cover different goals



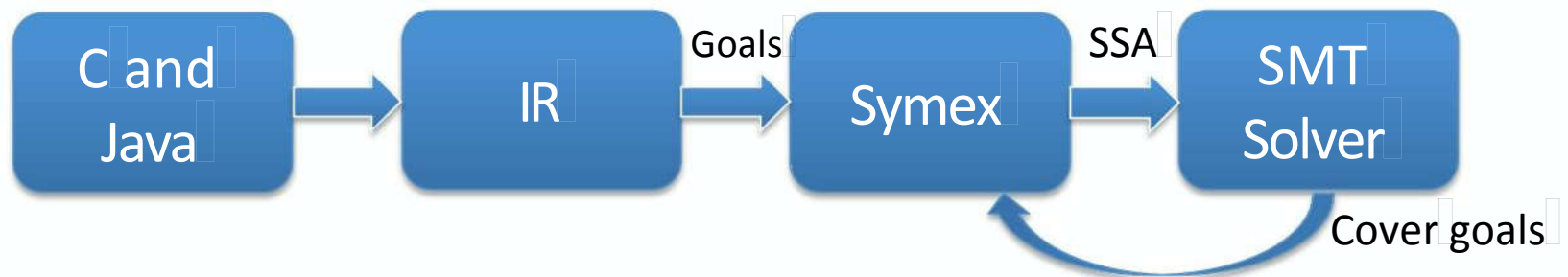
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- Translate the program to an **intermediate representation** (IR)
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- Solve the formula iteratively to cover different goals
- Interpret the solution to figure out the **input conditions**

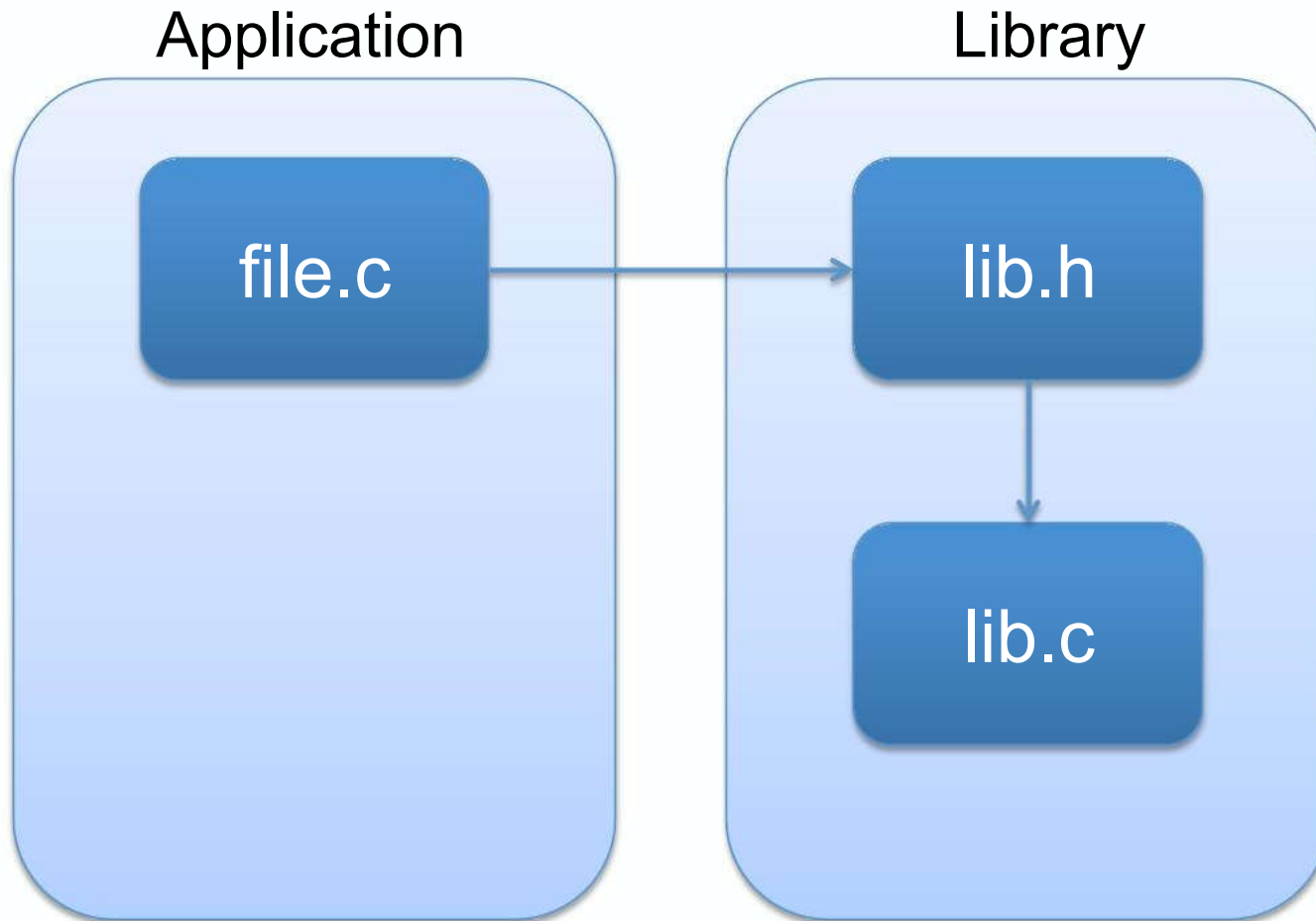


# BMC for Coverage Test Generation

- Translate the program to an **intermediate representation** (IR)
- Add goals indicating the **coverage**
  - *location, branch, decision, condition and path*
- **Symbolically** execute IR to produce an SSA program
- Translate the resulting SSA program into a **logical formula**
- Solve the formula iteratively to cover different goals
- Interpret the solution to figure out the **input conditions**
- Spit those input conditions out as a test case



# Coverage Test Generation Example



# Coverage Test Generation Example

file.c

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2
3 int64_t nondet_int64_t();
4 int main() {
5     int64_t a = nondet_int64_t();
6     int64_t b = nondet_int64_t();
7     int64_t r = nondet_int64_t();
8     if (mul(a, b, &r)) {
9         __ESBMC_assert(r == a * b, "Expected result
from multiplication");
10    }
11    return 0;
12 }
```

# Coverage Test Generation Example

lib.c

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         *res = 0;
6         return 1;
7     } else if(a == 1) {
8         *res = b;
9         return 1;
10    } else if(b == 1) {
11        *res = a;
12        return 1;
13    }
14    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
15    return 1;
16 }
```



# Coverage Test Generation Example

lib.h

```
1 #include<stdint.h>
2 _Bool mul(const int64_t a, const int64_t b,
int64_t *res);
```

```
esbmc main.c lib/lib.c --error-label GOALX -I lib/
```

# Program Instrumentation

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         GOAL1;;
6         *res = 0;
7         return 1;
8     } else if(a == 1) {
9         GOAL2;;
10        *res = b;
11        return 1;
12    } else if(b == 1) {
13        GOAL3;;
14        *res = a;
15        return 1;
16    }
17    GOAL4;;
18    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
19    return 1;
20 }
```

# Program Instrumentation (Goal1)

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         GOAL1;;
6         *res = 0;
7         return 1;
8     } else if(a == 1) {
9         GOAL2;;
10        *res = b;
11        return 1;
12    } else if(b == 1) {
13        GOAL3;;
14        *res = a;
15        return 1;
16    }
17    GOAL4;;
18    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
19    return 1;
20 }
```

# Generate Test Case for Goal1

```
esbmc main.c lib/lib.c --error-label GOAL1 -I lib/
```

Counterexample:

State 1 file main.c line 5 function main thread 0

-----  
a = 1 (00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000  
00000000 00000000 00000001)

State 2 file main.c line 6 function main thread 0

-----  
b = 0 (00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000  
00000000 00000000 00000000)

State 3 file lib.c line 5 function mul thread 0

-----

Violated property:

file lib.c line 5 function mul

error label

0

# Program Instrumentation (Goal2)

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         GOAL1;;
6         *res = 0;
7         return 1;
8     } else if(a == 1) {
9         GOAL2;;
10        *res = b;
11        return 1;
12    } else if(b == 1) {
13        GOAL3;;
14        *res = a;
15        return 1;
16    }
17    GOAL4;;
18    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
19    return 1;
20 }
```

# Generate Test Case for Goal2

```
esbmc main.c lib/lib.c --error-label GOAL2 -I lib/
```

Counterexample:

State 1 file main.c line 5 function main thread 0

-----  
a = 1 (00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000  
00000000 00000000 00000001)

State 2 file main.c line 6 function main thread 0

-----  
b = 1 (00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000  
00000000 00000000 00000001)

State 3 file lib.c line 9 function mul thread 0

-----

Violated property:

file lib.c line 9 function mul  
error label  
0

# Program Instrumentation (Goal3)

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         GOAL1;;
6         *res = 0;
7         return 1;
8     } else if(a == 1) {
9         GOAL2;;
10        *res = b;
11        return 1;
12    } else if(b == 1) {
13        GOAL3;;
14        *res = a;
15        return 1;
16    }
17    GOAL4;;
18    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
19    return 1;
20 }
```

# Generate Test Case for Goal3

```
esbmc main.c lib/lib.c --error-label GOAL3 -I lib/
```

Counterexample:

State 1 file main.c line 5 function main thread 0

-----  
a = -4537113969113143794 (11000001 00001000 11101110  
11100010 00111101 10001100 01100110 00001110)

State 2 file main.c line 6 function main thread 0

-----  
b = 1 (00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000  
00000000 00000000 00000001)

State 3 file lib.c line 13 function mul thread 0

-----

Violated property:

file lib.c line 13 function mul  
error label  
0



# Program Instrumentation (Goal4)

```
1 #include "lib.h"
2 _Bool mul(int64_t a, int64_t b, int64_t *res) {
3     // Trivial cases
4     if((a == 0) || (b == 0)) {
5         GOAL1;;
6         *res = 0;
7         return 1;
8     } else if(a == 1) {
9         GOAL2;;
10        *res = b;
11        return 1;
12    } else if(b == 1) {
13        GOAL3;;
14        *res = a;
15        return 1;
16    }
17    GOAL4;;
18    *res = a * b; // there exists an overflow
19    return 1;
20 }
```

# Generate Test Case for Goal4

```
esbmc main.c lib/lib.c --error-label GOAL4 -I lib/
```

Counterexample:

State 1 file main.c line 5 function main thread 0

-----  
a = 6917247552664371199 (01011111 11111110 11111111 11111111  
11111111 11111111 11111111 11111111)

State 2 file main.c line 6 function main thread 0

-----  
b = -1 (11111111 11111111 11111111 11111111 11111111  
11111111 11111111 11111111)

State 3 file lib.c line 17 function mul thread 0

-----

Violated property:

file lib.c line 17 function mul  
error label  
0

# Generate Test Case for Overflow

```
esbmc main.c lib/lib.c --overflow-check -I lib/
```

Counterexample:

State 1 file main.c line 5 function main thread 0

-----  
a = 4623516855184146434 (01000000 00101010 00001000  
00010101 01010110 01001000 01000000 00000010)

State 2 file main.c line 6 function main thread 0

-----  
b = 3 (00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000 00000000  
00000000 00000000 00000011)

State 3 file lib.c line 18 function mul thread 0

-----

Violated property:

file lib.c line 18 function mul  
arithmetic overflow on mul  
!overflow("\*", a, b)

# Summary

- Cost/precision tradeoffs
  - Blackbox is lightweight, easy and fast, but weak coverage
  - Whitebox is smarter but complex and slower
  - Recent “**semi-whitebox**” approaches
    - Less smart but more lightweight: **Flayer** (taint-flow analysis, may generate false alarms), **Bunny-the-fuzzer** (taint-flow, source-based, heuristics to fuzz based on input usage), **autodafe**, etc.

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- Which is more effective at finding bugs? It depends...
  - Many apps are buggy; any form of fuzzing finds bugs!
  - Once low-hanging bugs are gone, fuzzing must become smarter: use whitebox and/or user-provided guidance (grammars, etc.)

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  - Blackbox is lightweight, easy and fast, but weak coverage
  - Whitebox is smarter but complex and slower
  - Recent “**semi-whitebox**” approaches
    - Less smart but more lightweight: **Flayer** (taint-flow analysis, may generate false alarms), **Bunny-the-fuzzer** (taint-flow, source-based, heuristics to fuzz based on input usage), **autodafe**, etc.
- Which is more effective at finding bugs? It depends...
  - Many apps are buggy; any form of fuzzing finds bugs!
  - Once low-hanging bugs are gone, fuzzing must become smarter: use whitebox and/or user-provided guidance (grammars, etc.)
- Bottom line: in practice, **use both!**